

EMAIL SECURITY AWARENESS TRAINING

For All Employees | Consulting Firm Security Programme

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Why Email Security Matters

Email is the #1 entry point for cyber attacks against businesses

91% of cyber attacks start with a phishing email

\$4.9M average cost of a data breach in 2025

1 in 4 employees click on phishing links without training

You are the most important line of defense

Common Email Threats

Phishing

Fake emails that trick you into revealing passwords or clicking malicious links

Spoofing

Email that appears to come from someone you trust (CEO, IT team) but is actually a fraudster

Malware

Attachments or links that install viruses, ransomware, or spyware on your computer

Business Email Compromise

Sophisticated attacks targeting finance teams to authorize fraudulent wire transfers

Ransomware Delivery

Emails that encrypt your files and demand payment for recovery

What is Phishing?

Phishing tricks you into giving away sensitive information by pretending to be someone trustworthy.

Typical phishing email looks like:

From: support@goog1e-security.com *(Notice the 1 instead of l)*

Subject: URGENT: Your account will be suspended in 24 hours!

Dear Customer,

We noticed suspicious activity. Click here immediately to verify your account or it will be permanently suspended.

Verify Now -> <http://goog1e-verify.suspicious-domain.tk>

Google Security Team

5 Signs of a Phishing Email

1. Urgency

Threatens immediate consequences if you don't act NOW

2. Suspicious Sender

Email address looks similar but slightly off (goog1e instead of google)

3. Generic Greeting

'Dear Customer' or 'Dear User' instead of your name

4. Spelling/Grammar Errors

Professional companies rarely send emails with typos

5. Suspicious Links/Attachments

Hover over links - if URL doesn't match the company, don't click

Strong Password Practices

Best Practices

- Use at least 12 characters
- Mix uppercase, lowercase, numbers, symbols
- Use a password manager
- Use a different password for every account
- Change immediately if compromised

Avoid

- Reusing the same password
- Names, birthdays, common words
- Writing passwords on sticky notes
- Sharing passwords by email or chat
- Passwords like 'Password123'

Recommended password managers: Bitwarden, 1Password, KeePass

Two-Factor Authentication (MFA)

Even if your password is stolen, MFA blocks the attacker.

How it works:

1. You enter your password
2. App on your phone shows a 6-digit code
3. You enter the code to complete login

Result:

Even if someone steals your password, they can't get in without your phone.

Approved apps: Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator, Authy

MFA is MANDATORY for all company email accounts.

What is Email Encryption?

Encryption is like sending your letter in a locked box.

WITHOUT Encryption

Anyone intercepting your email can read it.

Example:

'Account password is: pass123'

Visible to: hackers, ISPs, anyone in between

WITH Encryption

Only the intended recipient can decrypt and read it.

Example:

'jA0EAwMC8x...mB6tD9='

Unreadable to anyone except the recipient

Use encryption for: client data, financial info, passwords, internal confidential communications

Suspicious Email? Here's What to Do

DO NOT

Click any links in the email

DO NOT

Reply or respond to the sender

DO NOT

Forward to colleagues or friends

DO NOT

Open any attachments

DO

Forward to phishing@consultingfirm.com

DO

Delete the email after IT confirms

Quick Reference: DOs and DON'Ts

DO

OK Verify sender before clicking links

OK Use MFA on all corporate accounts

OK Report suspicious emails to IT

OK Encrypt sensitive client data

OK Use strong, unique passwords

OK Lock your computer when leaving desk

DON'T

X Click links in unexpected emails

X Share passwords by any means

X Open attachments from unknown senders

X Send confidential data over personal email

X Reuse passwords across accounts

X Leave email open on shared computers

Quick Quiz - Test Your Knowledge

Q1: You get an urgent email from 'CEO' asking to wire \$50,000 immediately. What do you do?

- a) Wire immediately to avoid losing the deal
- b) Verify by calling the CEO directly on a known number
- c) Reply asking for more details
- d) Forward to a colleague for advice

Q2: A vendor email has an unexpected .zip attachment. Should you open it?

Yes / No / Verify with the vendor first?

Q3: What does SPF do in one sentence?

(Hint: It is one of the three records that prove an email actually came from where it claims to be from)

Answers: 1) b 2) Verify with the vendor first 3) SPF lists which servers are allowed to send mail from your domain

Thank You

Stay Safe. Stay Alert. Stay Secure.

Resources & Contacts

Report Phishing: phishing@consultingfirm.com
IT Helpdesk: helpdesk@consultingfirm.com
Security Concerns: security@consultingfirm.com